

Can you still get shredded if you break all the rules?



Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 18, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/1GMQj1MQLvM> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter rapidly debunks five common fitness rules — fasted cardio, cardio order, post-workout shakes, rest days, and workout timing — concluding none are strict requirements for getting shredded.

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Fasted Cardio 0:00

- **Verdict: Not necessary** — you can get shredded without doing fasted cardio
 - Fasted cardio does have some advantages
 - Cardio done after eating also has its own advantages
 - These advantages "basically cancel themselves out" — making it a non-critical choice

Cardio Before Lifting 0:14

- **Verdict: Suboptimal, but not a dealbreaker** — you can still get shredded, but it's not ideal
 - Recommended approach: do cardio at a separate time of day or on a completely different day from lifting
 - Doing cardio before weights is described as "never optimal"

Post-Workout Protein Shake Timing 0:22

- **Verdict: Immediate consumption not required** — the anabolic window is wider than people think
 - You have a window that "spans a few hours" after training
 - It's probably best to get protein in that window, but you don't need to rush

Rest Days 0:35

- **Verdict: Traditional rest days are optional** — staying active daily is what matters
 - Brandon says he doesn't really take rest days himself
 - He may skip the gym but remains active every single day
 - Examples of non-gym activity he counts:
 - Walking 10,000–15,000 steps
 - Taking his son to a trampoline park
 - Taking nieces and nephews to play laser tag
 - The key mindset: "I'm getting active on them days, man. I'm not messing around."

Morning vs. Night Workouts 0:45

- **Verdict: Timing doesn't matter** — working out at night is completely fine
 - A flat "Yeah, 100%" — no caveats given